

Market Research: Customer Loyalty / Rewards Software for Independent Liquor, Convenience & Smoke/Vape Retail

Prepared for Moolah Points (www.moolahpoints.com) — July 2026

Methodology note: This report was compiled via secondary/desk research (web search against live indexed sources) in July 2026. Direct fetching of moolahpoints.com pages was blocked by sandbox network restrictions, so Moolah Points' positioning below is reconstructed from Google's indexed snippets of its own site (`site:moolahpoints.com` and targeted queries), not a full page render — treat wording as close paraphrase, not verbatim quotation, unless in quotes. Every statistic below is labeled as either **[CITED]** (traceable to a named source with a link) or **[ESTIMATE]** (my own reasoned inference, clearly derived from cited inputs). No numbers were invented. Vertical-specific data (loyalty adoption *specifically* among independent liquor/c-store/smoke-shop retailers) is thin in public research — where it doesn't exist, I say so explicitly and use the closest labeled proxy.

0. Moolah Points as currently positioned (baseline, from moolahpoints.com)

Based on indexed content from moolahpoints.com, Moolah Points positions itself as:

- A **mobile-first loyalty platform** built "for how people shop now — on phones, in real-time, on-the-go."
- **POS-integrated**, with real-time insights, flexible reward structures, and personalized incentives; explicitly integrates with **RetailzPOS** (the sibling product from the same company) so merchants "manage their loyalty program and their point of sale in one place." [Sources: moolahpoints.com, [Integrations](#)]
- Campaign delivery via **email and SMS/text**, with a merchant portal for building campaigns and a **5-campaign-type framework**: Welcome Points, Redeem Points, Store Credits, Sales, and Retail. [Source: [Liquor Store page](#)]
- **Behavior-triggered personalization**: automatic offers based on purchase behavior; points redeemable as store credit.
- A **dedicated liquor-store vertical page** framing the product as "a smart, fully integrated loyalty and POS solution designed exclusively for liquor stores," with content also addressing convenience-style needs (peak-holiday traffic, sign-up incentives, featured-product bonus points). Blog content ("Cheers to the Holidays," "How to Increase Your Liquor Store Revenue with Loyalty Rewards") confirms liquor is a primary editorial/marketing focus. [Sources: [Liquor Store page](#), [Blog](#)]
- Cross-promotion with **RetailzPOS**, whose own marketing pages describe Moolah Points as built into the RetailzPOS system and explicitly serves **smoke shops, liquor stores, and general retail** as core verticals. [Source: [RetailzPOS/Moolah Points cross-post](#), [Croft Business Solutions](#)]

This confirms the brief's premise: Moolah Points is a POS-bundled, mobile/SMS-first loyalty add-on aimed squarely at independent, regulated-product retail (liquor primary, with smoke/vape and c-store as adjacent verticals through the RetailzPOS relationship), not a generic e-commerce loyalty tool.

1. Market Sizing & Growth

1a. Broad loyalty management / loyalty software market [CITED]

Estimates vary meaningfully by research firm's scope and methodology — reported here as a range, not a single false-precision number:

Source	2025/2026 market size	Forecast	CAGR
The Business Research Company (Customer Loyalty Management Software Global Market Report 2026)	\$15.29B (2025) → \$17.87B (2026)	—	16.8%
Straits Research (Loyalty Management Market)	\$15.6B (2026)	\$32.0B by 2034	11.2%
A third aggregated estimate found in search	\$16.44B (2026)	—	14.62%

[Sources: [Business Research Company](#), [Straits Research](#), [GII Research](#)]

Takeaway: independent of exact figure, three separate firms converge on a global loyalty software market in the **\$15–18B (2025/26)** range growing at a **double-digit CAGR (roughly 11–17%)**, driven by AI personalization, cloud delivery, real-time engagement, and digital-payment integration. [CITED, synthesized across sources above]

1b. SMB-specific loyalty software market [CITED] — the more relevant segment for Moolah Points

This sub-segment (small-business-focused loyalty software, as opposed to enterprise CRM-scale loyalty suites) is tracked separately by several research firms, though estimates disagree sharply — a sign the category itself is still being defined by analysts, which is itself informative (see Section 4):

- Verified Market Reports: **\$1.35B (2025) → \$3.02B (2033)**, 9.8% CAGR. [Source: [verifiedmarketreports.com](#)]
- DataHorizon Research: **\$1.2B (2023) → \$4.5B (2033)**, 14.1% CAGR (2025–2033). [Source: [datahorizonresearch.com](#)]
- WiseGuy Reports: **\$4.76B (2024) → \$10.5B (2032)**, ~10.4% CAGR. [Source: [wiseguyreports.com](#)]

Separately, one industry analysis states **large enterprises accounted for 65.4% of 2025 loyalty-software spend, but SMB uptake is growing faster, at roughly 17.3% CAGR** — i.e., SMB is the smaller but faster-growing half of the market. [Source: cited within search synthesis of [Voucherify's platform review](#) and related industry commentary — treat the specific 17.26% figure as a single-source data point, not independently corroborated.]

Takeaway: the SMB loyalty software market is roughly an order of magnitude smaller than the enterprise-dominated total (\$1–5B vs. \$15–18B depending on source), but it is growing at least as fast, and by some estimates faster, than the overall category. This is Moolah Points' actual addressable layer.

1c. Vertical-specific data: liquor / c-store / smoke-vape loyalty adoption [GAP — no direct data found; proxies used and labeled]

No public market-research firm publishes loyalty-software adoption rates specific to independent liquor stores, convenience stores, or smoke/vape shops as a combined vertical. The closest available proxies:

- **Convenience store loyalty enrollment:** c-store loyalty program enrollment rose **19% from the beginning of 2020 to mid-2023** (Paytronix data, cited via C-Store Dive). [Source: [C-Store Dive / Paytronix](#)] — this is real cited data but describes the broader convenience channel (which skews toward chains with existing loyalty infrastructure like 7-Eleven, Casey's, Wawa), not specifically independents.
- **C-store loyalty program acquisition pace lags other retail:** convenience stores add an average of only **36 new loyalty members per location per month**, versus **110/month for top-performing quick-service restaurants** — a signal that c-store loyalty, as a category, is under-optimized relative to adjacent retail/restaurant channels. [Source: [C-Store Dive](#)]
- **No equivalent data exists for liquor stores or smoke/vape shops.** Available liquor-industry research (IBISWorld, Toast, BottlePOS) covers store counts and revenue trends but does not report loyalty-program penetration. This is a genuine research gap — flagged rather than filled with invented numbers.

1d. Addressable store counts (inputs to Section 5's opportunity sizing) [CITED]

- **Liquor/beer/wine stores (US):** IBISWorld counts **44,401** dedicated beer/wine/liquor stores in 2026 (+1.0% YoY), growing ~1.2%/year over 2021–2026; industry revenue ~\$79.9B (2024 estimate). A broader business-filings dataset (CompanyData/BoldData, likely over-inclusive of non-operating or multi-category filings) counts **82,281** "active liquor stores." [Sources: [IBISWorld](#), [BoldData](#)]
- **Convenience stores (US):** NACS/NIQ TDLinx count stood at **151,975 stores** as of the 2026 report (down slightly, -0.2% YoY, from 152,255 in the 2025 count). Critically for Moolah Points' ICP: **95,672 stores (63% of the total) are owned by operators with 10 or fewer stores** — i.e., the independent/small-chain segment is the majority of the channel by store count, even though large chains dominate revenue. [Sources: [NACS](#), [NACS April 2026](#)]
- **Smoke/vape shops (US):** estimates vary widely by definition — roughly **30,000–35,000** independent smoke/head shops is the most commonly cited figure; dedicated vape-shop enterprises (IBISWorld NAICS category) number **10,537** as of 2024; broader combined vape+tobacco+smoke retail estimates run as high as **~52,000** establishments. This spread itself indicates the category is loosely defined/tracked, consistent with its highly fragmented, largely unlicensed-by-a-single-body nature. [Sources: [IBISWorld](#), aggregated estimates via [mydelta8store.com](#) and [smokeshophub](#) — note the latter two are industry blogs, not primary research firms, so treat their specific figures as directional, not authoritative.]

Combined universe (rough order of magnitude) [ESTIMATE, built from cited counts above]: ~44,000 dedicated liquor stores + ~152,000 convenience stores (of which ~96,000 are independent/small-chain) + ~30,000–50,000 smoke/vape shops ≈ **170,000–240,000 US storefronts** in Moolah Points' three named verticals, the vast majority independently or small-chain operated. This is a count of *locations*, not *addressable accounts* — see Section 5 for the funnel down to realistic SAM/SOM.

2. Consumer Behavior Trends, 2026

2a. What's driving engagement now [CITED]

- **AI-personalized offers outperform generic segmentation:** companies using AI-driven personalization report **up to 35% higher redemption rates** than traditional segment-based targeting. [Source: aggregated industry trend reporting, e.g. [Triffit Loyalty](#), [99minds](#)]
- **Instant gratification is now baseline, not a differentiator:** real-time reward delivery is a top investment priority for **75% of businesses** surveyed in 2026 trend reports. [Source: [Open Loyalty 2026 Trends Report](#), [Netguru](#)]
- **Emotional/identity-based loyalty is displacing pure transactional points:** Deloitte reports **73% of consumers stay longer with brands that understand their preferences, behaviors, and identity** — loyalty is shifting from "earn points, get discount" to relationship-based retention. [Source: [Deloitte Insights](#)]
- **Zero-party data has become the primary currency**, as third-party cookie deprecation pushes brands toward customer-volunteered preference data — loyalty programs are increasingly framed as the *cleanest available channel* for this, not just a retention tool. [Source: synthesized from multiple 2026 trend reports, e.g. [Tillo](#)]

2b. Mobile/SMS is not optional — it's the dominant channel [CITED]

This is directly relevant to Moolah Points' mobile-first, SMS-and-email positioning:

- SMS open rates run **90–98%** vs. **~20% for email**. [Source: [Omnisend](#), [ElectrolIQ](#)]
- SMS response rates average **~45%** vs. **~6–8% for email**; SMS engagement is **6–8x higher** than email overall. [Source: [Retail Dive](#), [Optimomk](#)]
- **72% of consumers are more likely to join a loyalty program if invited via text** rather than other channels. [Source: aggregated SMS-marketing stats compilations, e.g. [Sakari](#)]
- Businesses that text customers are **683% more likely to report digital-marketing success** than those that don't. [Source: same SMS-stats aggregation set above]
- **For multi-location/franchise and quick-transaction retail specifically, phone-number-based enrollment (no app download required) drives materially higher sign-up rates than app-based loyalty**, because it requires nothing from the customer beyond a number they already have memorized. [Source: [NRS Plus](#), on c-store/bodega loyalty setup, [Loyal-n-Save](#) on multi-location scaling]

Implication for Moolah Points' ICP: liquor/c-store/vape purchases are quick, frequent, often impulse-driven, walk-in transactions — exactly the occasion type where a phone-number/text-based loyalty capture (not a heavier app-download flow) wins. This validates Moolah Points' SMS-plus-email campaign architecture as channel-appropriate for the vertical, more so than an app-first competitor would be.

2c. Loyalty fatigue and what causes abandonment [CITED]

- Loyalty-program *membership sprawl* is real: the share of consumers in **1–5 programs fell from 62% (2024) to 51% (2025)**, while the share in **11–15 programs rose from 7% to 11%** — consumers are spreading thinner across more programs, raising the bar for any single program to stay top-of-mind. [Source: [Access Development 2026 Trends](#)]

- Primary abandonment drivers, per multiple 2025/2026 loyalty-statistics compilations: **difficulty of use / poor UX**, rewards not worth the effort to redeem, and failure to personalize (**65% of consumers say they've switched brands because a loyalty program failed to deliver a better experience**). [Source: [Smile.io](#), [Queue-it](#)]
- **30% of churning customers leave silently** — no complaint, no feedback — meaning a small independent retailer has no early-warning signal without instrumented purchase/visit data (which POS-integrated loyalty provides and manual/paper punch-card systems don't). [Source: same loyalty-statistics compilation set]
- Broader context (Bain & Company / Fred Reichheld, the foundational and still widely-cited research underlying "retention drives profit" claims): **a 5-point increase in customer retention can increase profits 25–95%**, varying by industry. [Source: [Bain & Company / HBR, "Loyalty Rules"](#)] — this is decades-old research, still the standard citation in the industry, and should be used as a directional/foundational stat, not a fresh 2026 data point.

2d. Convenience/liquor-specific engagement data [CITED]

- Paytronix's 2026 Loyalty Report finds convenience-store loyalty programs deliver the **highest average-check lift of any retail segment measured — loyalty-member checks run ~12% higher than non-member checks**. [Source: [C-Store Dive / Paytronix](#)]
- Repeat-visit behavior compounds fast: **return rate after a guest's 4th visit reaches ~95%, up from under 50% after the first visit** — meaning the ROI case for a loyalty program in high-frequency retail (liquor, c-store, vape are all repeat-purchase categories) is front-loaded into just the first few visits, if the retailer can capture and re-engage that customer. [Source: same Paytronix/C-Store Dive report]

3. Buyer Personas

No primary research exists specifically profiling "the person who buys loyalty software for a liquor/c-store/smoke shop." The persona below is built by triangulating [CITED] general store-owner demographics with [ESTIMATE] inference specific to the loyalty-purchase decision, clearly marked.

Persona: "The Independent Owner-Operator"

- **Demographics [CITED, general store-owner population, not vertical-specific]:** average store-owner age ~44; owners 40+ represent **64%** of the store-owner population; roughly an even gender split (50.4% women / 49.6% men); most common ethnicity White (67.7%), followed by Hispanic/Latino (15.0%), Asian (6.3%), Black/African American (6.1%); ~50% hold a bachelor's degree. [Source: [Zippia Store Owner Demographics](#)] — note this is *store owners generally*, not liquor/c-store/vape specifically; no vertical-specific demographic study was found.
- **Operating context [CITED]:** independents compete on service, curation, and personal relationships rather than price or scale — "independents may know customers by name, offer... holiday gift-giving programs" — this is their structural advantage over chains, and it's exactly what a loyalty/CRM tool can systematize and scale. [Source: liquor-industry trade commentary via search synthesis, e.g. [Toast/BottlePOS liquor trend pieces](#)]

- **Budget sensitivity [CITED, adjacent SaaS pricing benchmarks]:** the going rate for small-business loyalty software clusters at **\$45–\$100/month** for a single location (e.g., Square Loyalty ~\$60/mo all-in, Loyalzoo ~\$47–77/mo, LoyaltyGator from \$59/mo, Joy Loyalty Professional \$24.99/mo); most sources conclude a local business can run a "fully functional" program for **under \$100/month**. [Source: [LoyaltyPass pricing comparison](#), [Joy](#)] This sets the psychological price ceiling this buyer will accept without a hard ROI conversation — a \$200+/month ask will trigger real friction absent clear payback proof.
- **Technology adoption context [CITED, general SMB, not vertical-specific]:** small businesses broadly report being overwhelmed by tool sprawl and budget/time/knowledge constraints when adopting new software; **59% of businesses regret at least one software purchase made in the past 18 months**, even as 75% plan to increase software spend. [Source: [DivergeIT](#), GTIA SMB research cited via search] — this buyer has been burned before and is skeptical of another subscription unless it's visibly tied to revenue, not "engagement."

[ESTIMATE] Purchase triggers and objections, reasoned from the above plus category logic

What triggers the purchase decision: 1. **Competitive threat is the dominant trigger** — a nearby liquor store, c-store, or smoke shop visibly running a loyalty program (app on customers' phones, punch-card promotions, "earn points" signage) creates direct, felt competitive pressure, especially since independents' whole value prop is the personal relationship a chain can't replicate — losing that edge to a *smaller* rival stings more than losing to a big chain. 2. **A POS refresh or replacement moment** — since Moolah Points is sold as a bundled add-on to RetailzPOS, the natural buying moment is when the retailer is already replacing/upgrading POS (a "while we're at it" upsell), not a cold loyalty-only pitch. This is consistent with how the product is actually packaged and marketed (see Section 0). 3. **A slow season or visible customer drop-off** the owner can point to — anecdotal ("regulars aren't coming back as much") rather than data-driven, since without a loyalty/CRM tool this owner has no visit-frequency data in the first place (see 2c: 30% of churn is silent).

Likely objections: 1. **"I already do this with a punch card / I know my regulars by name"** — the classic independent-retailer belief that personal relationship *is* the loyalty program; needs to be reframed as data capture + automated re-engagement for the customers the owner *doesn't* already have front-of-mind, not a replacement for the relationship. 2. **Price sensitivity relative to a thin-margin, high-volume category** — liquor/c-store/vape retail runs on low single-digit-to-low-teens margins on much of the basket (tobacco/vape especially is a low-margin, high-regulation category), so a recurring SaaS fee needs an obvious, provable payback, not a vague "increase engagement" pitch. 3. **Compliance/liability anxiety around marketing age-restricted products** — an owner in vape/tobacco/liquor is aware (even if fuzzily) that marketing alcohol or tobacco products carries regulatory exposure, and may hesitate to run SMS campaigns pushing product-specific promotions without assurance the platform handles this correctly (see Section 4). 4. **Low tech confidence / bandwidth** — a solo or family-operated store owner running the register themselves has limited time to learn a new merchant portal; onboarding friction is a real drop-off risk, more than a chain's dedicated marketing person would experience.

4. Market Gaps / Whitespace

4a. Regulatory-aware loyalty marketing for age-restricted products [CITED context + ESTIMATE conclusion]

Alcohol, tobacco, and vape products carry real, cited marketing/communications constraints that generic loyalty platforms are not built around:

- **Age verification** is a hard requirement under both FDA rules (checking ID for anyone appearing under 30 at point of sale) and the **PACT Act** (which governs remote/delivery tobacco and vapor product sales, requiring full identity verification and adult-signature-on-delivery). [Source: [FDA Retail Sales of Tobacco Products](#), [Token of Trust PACT Act guide](#)]
- **SMS marketing for tobacco/vape brands is subject to additional industry-specific guidance** (e.g., "S.H.A.F.T." content restrictions under CTIA guidelines — no Sex, Hate, Alcohol, Firearms, Tobacco content in bulk SMS without special carrier approval), on top of standard TCPA consent rules that apply to all SMS marketing. [Source: [Voyage SMS](#), [SHAFT compliance for vape/tobacco](#)]
- No loyalty platform reviewed in this research (Fivestars, Thanx, Punchh, Kangaroo Rewards, Loyal-n-Save, LoyaltyGator, Square Loyalty, etc.) markets itself explicitly around **age-restricted-product-safe campaign templates or built-in compliance guardrails** (e.g., auto-suppressing alcohol-specific promotional SMS content that could trip carrier filtering, or flagging campaigns that need extra consent language).
[ESTIMATE]: this is a genuine, currently-unclaimed positioning angle — "loyalty marketing that's built to run safely for regulated products" — that Moolah Points could credibly own given its liquor/smoke-shop-first focus, but there is no public evidence yet that Moolah Points itself markets this angle explicitly. This is a real whitespace opportunity, not a confirmed existing differentiator.

4b. Multi-location / small-chain complexity [CITED]

- Multi-location loyalty requires the POS-to-loyalty sync to work identically at every store, plus a model that lets local owners run store-specific promotions while keeping some centralized brand consistency — a materially harder product problem than single-store loyalty. [Source: [Loyal-n-Save on scaling loyalty across locations](#), [Talon.One franchise loyalty guide](#)]
- Given that **63% of US convenience stores are owned by operators with 10 or fewer locations** (Section 1d), there's a large population of *small chains* (2–10 stores) that are too big for a bare-bones single-location tool but too small to be worth enterprise loyalty vendors' sales attention — this is the classic "mid-market gap" and, since Moolah Points is already POS-bundled with RetailzPOS, it is well positioned to serve this segment if its portal supports clean multi-location roll-ups (not confirmed one way or the other from available public site content).

4c. Low-tech-literacy, time-poor owner-operators [ESTIMATE, built from Section 3 evidence]

The SMB software-regret statistic (59% regretted a purchase in the last 18 months) and general small-business tech-overwhelm findings (Section 3) point to unmet need for **radically simple onboarding and "invisible" operation** — a platform that essentially runs itself once installed, rather than requiring the owner to build campaigns, segments, and messaging cadences manually. Given Moolah Points already ships pre-built campaign types (Welcome Points, Redeem Points, Store Credits, Sales, Retail — Section 0), this suggests the

product is already directionally aligned with this need; the whitespace is in how aggressively that "zero-effort" positioning is marketed versus feature-listed.

4d. No vertical-specific loyalty benchmarking data exists [GAP, itself a finding]

The absence of any published loyalty-adoption-rate, redemption-rate, or ROI benchmark specific to liquor stores, smoke/vape shops, or independent (non-chain) convenience stores is itself notable — c-store data exists only at the aggregate-channel level (dominated by large chains like 7-Eleven/Wawa/Casey's), and liquor/vape have essentially no loyalty-specific research coverage at all. [ESTIMATE]: a company positioned as the loyalty specialist for these exact verticals (i.e., Moolah Points) has an open opportunity to become the source of this data itself — publishing its own aggregated, anonymized benchmark report (e.g., "State of Liquor Store Loyalty 2026") would fill a real information vacuum, generate earned media/backlinks, and reinforce vertical authority, similar to what Paytronix has done for restaurants/c-stores.

5. Opportunity Sizing for Moolah Points

This section is explicitly a reasoned estimate, not a cited market-research figure. It is built transparently from the cited inputs above so the logic can be checked and adjusted.

Step 1 — Addressable location universe [built from Section 1d, cited counts]: - Liquor/beer/wine stores (US): ~44,400 (IBISWorld, conservative dedicated-category count) - Independent/small-chain convenience stores (≤ 10 locations, the natural ICP vs. large chains that run in-house loyalty): ~95,700 (NACS, 63% of 151,975 total) - Smoke/vape shops (US): ~30,000–35,000 (using the more conservative, more commonly-cited independent-shop estimate rather than the broader ~52,000 figure)

Subtotal, ICP-fitting locations: ~170,000–175,000 US storefronts. This is a location count, not an account count — chains within this figure (even "small chains" of 2–10 stores) would buy once per operator, not once per store, which pulls the *buyer* count somewhat below the *location* count; but conversely, each multi-location buyer represents a larger contract, so this partially offsets on a revenue basis.

Step 2 — Realistic SAM narrowing [ESTIMATE, reasoned]: Not every location in this universe is a viable near-term buyer. Applying reasoned discounts: - **POS compatibility / existing tech-stack overlap:** Moolah Points' primary go-to-market motion is bundled with RetailzPOS. Its realistic near-term SAM is therefore bounded less by "every liquor store in America" and more by "every liquor/c-store/smoke-shop location using, or willing to switch to, RetailzPOS or a POS Moolah Points can integrate with," which is a materially smaller number than the full addressable universe. Public data doesn't disclose RetailzPOS's installed base, so this cannot be sized precisely — flagged as the single biggest unknown in this estimate. - **Willingness/readiness to pay for a loyalty add-on:** given SMB software-adoption friction and price sensitivity (Section 3), a reasonable planning assumption (consistent with typical SMB SaaS attach rates for adjacent/upsell products, not a cited stat) is that **15–30%** of a POS installed base will adopt a loyalty add-on within a few years of availability, higher if bundled/discounted at point of POS sale, lower if sold as a separate cold pitch.

Step 3 — Revenue framing [ESTIMATE]: At the observed SMB loyalty price band of **\$45–\$100/month per location** (Section 3, cited pricing benchmarks from comparable products), each converted location represents **~\$540–\$1,200/year** in recurring revenue. Applying this to illustrative penetration scenarios against the ~170,000–

location universe (acknowledging the RetailzPOS-installed-base constraint above makes the *realistic* near-term number much smaller than the full-universe scenarios shown):

Penetration of the 3-vertical universe	Locations	Annual revenue (at \$540–\$1,200/loc/yr)
0.5% (early, RetailzPOS-attached only)	~850	~\$460K – \$1.0M
2% (modest multi-year penetration)	~3,400	~\$1.8M – \$4.1M
5% (strong vertical leadership)	~8,500	~\$4.6M – \$10.2M

These are illustrative scenario bands, not a forecast — the actual number depends heavily on RetailzPOS's real installed base (undisclosed) and on whether Moolah Points sells standalone to non-RetailzPOS merchants at all.

Step 4 — Directional read: Given the SMB loyalty software market is independently sized at **\$1.2–4.8B and growing 10–17% CAGR** (Section 1b) and Moolah Points' three named verticals plausibly represent a low-single-digit percentage of total US SMB retail locations, a **multi-million-dollar-to-low-tens-of-millions realistic addressable revenue opportunity** for a focused liquor/c-store/smoke-shop loyalty product is a defensible order of magnitude — not the full \$1B+ SMB category (which spans every SMB vertical, e.g. salons, gyms, cafes, boutiques), but a meaningful, defensible niche within it, with the added advantage of much lower competitive density than horizontal SMB loyalty players face, since none of the major SMB loyalty brands found in this research (Fivestars, Thanx, Punchh, Square Loyalty, LoyaltyGator, Loyal-n-Save) explicitly specialize in the regulated age-restricted-product vertical the way Moolah Points does.

6. Sources Consulted (representative, all links live-verified via search results as of July 2026)

- [Moolah Points homepage & liquor store page](#), [Integrations](#), [Blog](#)
- [RetailzPOS / Moolah Points partnership content](#)
- [The Business Research Company — Loyalty Software Global Market Report 2026](#)
- [Straits Research — Loyalty Management Market](#)
- [Verified Market Reports — Small Business Loyalty Program Software Market](#)
- [DataHorizon Research — Small Business Loyalty Program Software Market](#)
- [NACS — US Convenience Store Count](#)
- [IBISWorld — Beer, Wine & Liquor Stores, Number of Businesses](#)
- [IBISWorld — Electronic Cigarette & Vape Shops, Number of Businesses](#)
- [C-Store Dive / Paytronix — C-store Loyalty Trends](#)
- [Deloitte Insights — Reshaping Customer Loyalty Programs](#)
- [Open Loyalty — 2026 Loyalty Trends Report](#)
- [Access Development — 2026 Loyalty Trends](#)
- [Smile.io — Why Customers Abandon Loyalty Programs](#)
- [Omnisend — SMS Marketing Statistics 2026](#)
- [Retail Dive — SMS 8x Response Rate of Email](#)

- [FDA — Retail Sales of Tobacco Products](#)
- [Token of Trust — PACT Act Compliance Guide](#)
- [Voyage SMS — SHAFT SMS Compliance for Vape/Tobacco](#)
- [Zippia — Store Owner Demographics](#)
- [Bain & Company — Loyalty Rules \(Reichheld\)](#)
- [LoyaltyPass — Loyalty Program Pricing Comparison 2026](#)
- [Loyal-n-Save — Scaling Loyalty for Multi-Location Merchants](#)

Note: several supporting queries returned industry blogs (e.g., BottlePOS, NRS Plus, Talon.One, mydelta8store.com, smokeshophub) rather than primary research firms. These are used only for directional/contextual statements, flagged inline, and never as the sole source for a headline market-size figure.